

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 999

By Jones R

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Mabel Chandler Edwards on the occasion of her 106th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, born on Leap Day, February 29, 1920, Mabel Chandler Edwards is celebrating her 106th birthday, a milestone commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Edwards has lived an amazing life and has experienced firsthand the breadth and span of American history; and

WHEREAS, the youngest daughter of John Frank Chandler and Vina Elizabeth Willis Chandler, Mabel Edwards grew up alongside her siblings Ishma, Bertha, and Mary; and

WHEREAS, at the age of eleven, she embraced Christianity and became a member of Clear Branch Baptist Church, where she has maintained her membership faithfully throughout her life; and

WHEREAS, while attending Milligan College to study home economics, Mrs. Edwards began writing to Walter Clinton Edwards, a neighbor and United States Army serviceman who would become her husband in 1942; and

WHEREAS, Walter and Mabel Edwards welcomed a son, David C. Edwards, in 1943; and

WHEREAS, over the course of her husband's twenty-year military career, Mabel Edwards and her family lived at various Army bases in Florida, Illinois, Germany, and other locations before returning to Tennessee, where they eventually settled in Erwin and built their home; and

WHEREAS, Mabel Edwards enjoyed sixty-seven years of marriage with her husband until his passing in 2009; and

WHEREAS, throughout her life, Mrs. Edwards has enjoyed gardening and raising flowers, especially her vibrant geraniums, which she carefully overwintered and replanted each spring; she also continued to grow tomato and bell pepper plants behind her home until the age of 103; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Edwards remains a beloved member of her community who is admired for her faith, integrity, and enthusiasm for life; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Mabel Chandler Edwards on the celebration of her 106th birthday and extend to her our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.